

# TEAM LEADERS

Team Leader Manual · Southeast Students

2026–2027

© 2026 Southeast Students. All Rights Reserved.
No portion of this book may be reproduced in any form
without permission from the publisher, except as permitted by U.S. copyright law.

For permissions contact:
Justin Davis · jdavis@secc.org

WHAT'S INSIDE

# CONTENTS


01 **Mission + Mantras** 03
WHO WE ARE

02 **Team Leaders** 07
WHAT WE DO

03 **Key Conversations** 15
1-ON-1 CONVOS

04 **Team Dialogues** 17
TEAM MEETINGS

05 **Big Three** 39
MSM + HSM

06 **Further Resources** 43
LEARN MORE

01

SECTION 01

# MISSION + MANTRAS

The GPS that keeps every ministry effort on course.

# WHO WE ARE

As members of the body of Christ, we seek Great Commission and Great Commandment living **(Matt. 22:37–40 · Matt. 28:18–20).**

As members of this local body of Christ called Southeast, we seek to live this way through connecting people to Jesus and one another, utilizing some metaphors based on the life of Christ to keep us focused.

**You, as a Team Leader over a Student Ministry team, are the culture carrier of our Mission and Mantras.** You should frequently use them as a GPS to keep our ministry efforts focused on accomplishing Great Commission and Great Commandment living.

WHO WE ARE

# MISSION + MANTRAS

## MISSION

CONNECTING

PEOPLE

TO JESUS

AND

ONE ANOTHER

## VISION

TO UNLEASH

THE FULL FORCE

OF THE CHURCH

TO LOVE PEOPLE

ONE AT A TIME

## METAPHORS FROM THE LIFE OF CHRIST

### BE THE BRANCH ( JOHN 15:1–17 )

We connect in community.
We value connection *to* Jesus over production *for* Jesus.

### CATCH THE WIND ( JOHN 3:1–8 )

We connect the full force of the church with the Holy Spirit.
We value risk and adventure over safety and comfort.

### WRECK THE ROOF ( LUKE 5:18–25 )

We will radically love people one at a time.
We value innovation over tradition.

### GRIP THE PLOW ( LUKE 9:57–62 )

We serve with intentional and focused effort.
We value personal engagement over attendance.

### EMPTY THE JAR ( LUKE 7:36–50 )

We connect through sacrificial generosity.
We value expressive worship over religious rituals.

02

SECTION 02

# TEAM LEADERS

A leader of leaders—a shepherd.

TEAM LEADERS

# THE HEART OF A SHEPHERD

**You win when your team feels cared for, knows where they are going, and accomplishes the mission God has given us.** Keep the heart of a shepherd at the forefront of everything you do.

The primary reason you have this manual is to help you better shepherd your team over time. In this section are key resources around expectations, building teams, developing others, and helping new leaders.

In further sections, you'll be teed up for **Key Conversations** with the individuals on your team—a mix of planned and "as you go" conversations. To help unify the individuals you lead, there is also a section dedicated to facilitating **Team Dialogues**.

Both are there for your support. You are free to add for your team's context, but this is the minimum we expect you to follow!

IF JESUS WAS A TEAM LEADER

# LUKE 9 RHYTHMS

Five rhythms for leader culture, and the tools we use to live them based on the Luke 9 ministry team.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| COMMUNITY | *"Jesus called the twelve together..."* **Luke 9:1a** | → HANGOUTS<br>→ HUDDLES<br>→ TEAM MEETINGS |
| EQUIPPING | *"He gave them power and authority..."* **Luke 9:1b** | → UNLEASHED LEADERS<br>→ BIG 3<br>→ TRAININGS |
| MISSION | *"He sent them out..."* **Luke 9:2** | → SCHOOL ENGAGEMENT<br>→ COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT |
| CARE | *"They all ate and were satisfied..."* **Luke 9:17** | → TEAM LEADERS<br>→ SHEPHERDING |
| RETREAT | *"Jesus was praying in private and his disciples were with him..."* **Luke 9:18** | → OVERNIGHTS<br>→ CELEBRATIONS |

STUDENT MINISTRY

# ROLE OVERVIEW

## STAFF

- Shepherding Team Leaders
- Keeping the whole ministry on mission
- Being examples to the flock **1 Peter 5:2–4**
- Equipping Team Leaders

## TEAM LEADER

- Shepherding a team of leaders
- Keeping your team focused on the mission
- Setting the pace for your teams
- Leading by example for your team **1 Cor. 11:1**

## LEADER

- Shepherding students
- Initiating investment in a few
- Living out your spiritual gifts in the context of your team and the ministry in which you serve

## SUPPORT LEADER

- Plugging new and unconnected students in
- Supporting ministry efforts
- Engaging students and families

TEAM LEADER

# EXPECTATIONS 1–3

Team Leaders play a vital role in ensuring we have effective teams mobilized to multiply disciples all around the cities of every SE Campus.

## 01 Live the Mission

- You set the pace for how your team uniquely lives the mission to your students.
- If you are passive, your leaders will be passive, therefore making students passive.

## 02 Meet with Leaders

Pray for, care for and coach leaders on your team.

- Ask them how their walk with Christ is going
- Ask them about their life—family, work, school, hobbies
- Ask them about their ministry using the Key Conversations
- Pray together // Call to action

## 03 Own Student Connections for Your Team

- Ensure students are being invited regularly
- In partnership with Guest Experience, have a plan for connecting new students into the right group with the right leader
- Know and understand the different groups represented within your team

TEAM LEADER

# EXPECTATIONS 4–7

## 04 Lead Team Meetings

- Lead spiritually—bring God's Word, the life of Christ, 4 Chairs, our mission and values into conversations often
- Organize calendar dates and important information for the team
- Lead the Semester Planning meeting (2x / year)
- Pray, Plan, Prepare, Pursue

## 05 Live the Mantras

- Ensure you and the team are embodying our mantras
- Set measurable goals and hold the team accountable

## 06 Encourage Investment in a Few

- Lead by example on investing in a few
- Hold the team accountable to identifying and discipling a few students

## 07 Know Your Camp Strategy

- Lead your team's strategy for "who's your one?"
- Prepare your team for next steps and follow up post camp

TEAM LEADER

# EXPECTATIONS 8–10

## 08 Parent & Community Partnerships

- Maintain relationships with parents and other community partners
- Know the schools your students attend and identify partners within those schools
- Always seek new leaders through these relationships

## 09 Evaluate with Your Team Each Semester

- Look for where God is moving and praise Him
- Identify areas of improvement or need for course corrections

## 10 Culture Carrier

You set the temperature for your team. You bring the urgency.

- Be an example worth following
- Be a branch that is connected to the vine **John 15**

“

**IF WE BELIEVE THE COMMAND TO ‘MAKE DISCIPLES’ IS BIGGER AND MORE BEAUTIFUL THAN MERELY MAKING CONVERTS AND CALLING PEOPLE TO ‘MAKE A DECISION,’ THEN WE UNDERSTAND THE ESSENTIAL ROLE OF THE CHURCH IS MATURING PEOPLE IN CHRIST.**

— ERIC GEIGER

03

SECTION 03

# KEY CONVOS

Monthly coaching conversations with individuals on your team to help you shepherd wholisticly.

1-ON-1S WITH YOUR TEAM

# KEY CONVERSATIONS

Throughout the semester you'll have plenty of side conversations, hall conversations, random, text and phone conversations with your team.

**However, a shepherd doesn't randomly walk with his sheep. A shepherd has a plan for where he is taking his sheep.**

The following pages are Key Conversations to have with individuals on your team, meant to be led one-on-one or, if necessary, one-on-a-few. The reason is simple: honesty and vulnerability can be hard to achieve in group settings. Pulling teammates aside for these conversations over time will be fruitful.

Depending on the size of your team, you might need more or less time. They will require you to intentionally put days and times on the calendar. Our prayer is that these conversations grow your friendships with your teammates, as well as set you up to lead them like Jesus.

04

SECTION 04

# TEAM DIALOGUES

Monthly meeting agendas for you to keep you team on the same page and moving forward together.

MONTHLY TEAM MEETINGS

# TEAM DIALOGUES

Each month, pull your team together to dialogue about important details of your ministry. These meetings should be planned, preferably at a recurring time, for the best turnout. Identify with your team the best day and time for everyone.

At times these meetings will require sacrifice for some teammates. If good friendships are building, over time you'll find a rhythm and people will naturally make it a priority to spend time together as a team.

**Never cancel your standing meeting**—you may do more harm than good to the culture of consistency. If someone can't make it, relay the important details.

These monthly subjects don't need your entire time together. We hope you share meals, hang out, and enjoy one another as part of these times!

# AUG SPIRITUAL INVENTORY



*Send the* ***Spiritual Disciplines Evaluation*** *to your leaders before you meet up. Use it as a base for conversation around how they are doing spiritually.*

- Entering into this school year, where is your spiritual health?
- How has your quiet time with Jesus been? How regularly are you spending time alone with God?
- What have you been praying about?
- Where has God been growing you? What would you like God to grow you in this year?
- How do you think you can best contribute to our team this year? What can you uniquely bring to the table?
- What do you need from me to help you succeed as a leader?

**BEFORE NEXT TIME**

Have them take the **4 Chair Disciple Making Personal Inventory** (scan the code) before your next meet up—you'll discuss the results together.

SCRIPTURE **HEBREWS 12:11**

# AUG SEMESTER PLANNING



*Do the hard work up front so everyone knows what to expect during the semester.*

- Have everyone come prepared with their notable calendar dates.
  *Vacations · celebrations & family birthdays · any time they expect to be unable to lead*
- Walk through the Ministry Calendar—leader dates, events, and fixed calendar items. Encourage your team to flag conflicts; note their dates for later.
- Map out your Team Meeting dates that go beyond our Leader Huddles.
- If your team can plan extra student events beyond program time, leave this meeting with those dates locked in.
- Move things around during the semester as needed, but do so as a team.

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Next month we will look at organizing your groups for the semester ahead.



**FALL SEMESTER PLANNING SHEET**

Scan to download & print for this meeting.

# 4 CHAIRS



- What challenge from Jesus goes with Chair 1? Chair 2? Chair 3? Chair 4?
- Based on the 4 Chair Disciple Making Inventory, what chair do you sit in? Do you agree or disagree? Why?
- What rhythm could you add, or change, in your life to help you get to the next chair?
- Read John 15. What level of fruitfulness are you currently experiencing? No fruit, Fruit, More Fruit or Much Fruit?
- How could you use the 4 Challenges of Jesus to better understand where students are and how to help them move to the next seat?

**LOOKING AHEAD**

As you form relationships with students in your grade, begin thinking about which chair each of them might be sitting in. The purpose is not to judge where someone is, but to **identify how you might help them take their next step!**

SCRIPTURE **1 JOHN 2:6**

# SEP ORGANIZING GROUPS



- Looking at our groups from last year, plus incoming students, what adjustments do we need to make for this year?

- Do our groups have space to grow as they invite friends in? Where can new students connect into our ministry?

- One size doesn't fit all. What creative ideas could make groups the best possible experience?

  ***Ideas:*** *Start with large group before breaking out. Do one large group per month. Strategic large group dates, primarily small groups.*

The advantage of a large group of your whole grade: students become familiar with all the leaders—displaying what a team looks like enhances community among your grade.

> **LOOKING AHEAD**
>
> Start thinking of and **praying for future co-laborers** who God might bring onto your team.

# OCT SMALL GROUP



- How has small group started off for you?
- Do you know the names of your students? Do they know each other's names?
- Have you been able to connect with some of your students outside of group time?
- What is your plan for helping students get to the next seat spiritually?

## GROUP EVALUATION · FOUR CHAIRS

What percentage of the students in your group are in each chair? List a few names in each.

| 1 COME & SEE | 2 COME & FOLLOW | 3 BE WITH ME | 4 REMAIN IN ME |
|---|---|---|---|
| % | % | % | % |
| NAMES | NAMES | NAMES | NAMES |

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Next month we'll talk about your few. Bring **3 names of students** you are personally investing in.

# OCT RECRUITING FRIENDS



- How would we say our team relationships are going? If we invited someone to join our team, what kind of environment would they be walking into?
- Who are some friends of ours who are not actively serving in any capacity?
- Who are some parents of our students who might be willing to join our mission?
- Who are some community partners who might join us or support us?

**Praying for coworkers:** take the names above and pray as a team for God to bring co-laborers to join your team and mission.

> **LOOKING AHEAD**
>
> Next month, plan to do something fun as a team—backyard fire, movie night, go-karting, axe throwing, dinner party, board game night, church together... Get it on the calendar soon, and **consider inviting those you are recruiting** to check out the community they could join!

# NOV YOUR FEW

- Who are your few?

- How are you intentionally walking with them?

- What would it look like for you to ask your few to commit to a set time period to meet up for a Bible study?

- Who are you and your few praying for that doesn't know Jesus?

- How could you lead your few in getting their friends in front of the gospel?

**LOOKING AHEAD**

An unleashed life is what Jesus calls us to. If we aren't actively pursuing students in their world, we give them a shallow example of God's love. **Jesus came to us—that is why we go to students.** Next time we'll look at our commitment to live an unleashed life together.

SCRIPTURE **MATTHEW 17:1–14**

# NOV COMM(UNITY)



*Read* **Acts 2:42–47** *together. There is nothing more powerful than a community on mission—the early church was a force for Kingdom advancement simply because of the gravitational pull their community had on the lost world around them.*

- What were the key markers of early church believers?
- Where does our team look like this kind of community? Where does it differ?
- The early church didn't separate adults, adolescents and children into micro communities. Do we consider our team "in community" with the students we minister to?
- Are we partnering with our students in the mission to reach their one?
- What changes do we need to make to enhance our community on mission together?

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Next month we will evaluate our fall semester together.

# DEC UNLEASHED LIFE



- Do you have a regular plan for meeting students in their world?
- Unleashed living requires complete dependence on God. How is being unleashed growing you personally?
- How would you rate yourself on living unleashed? What ideas did you try this semester—what worked, what didn't?
- Who is someone new you met that you are praying for?

---

## NAME A STUDENT FOR EACH LEVEL OF RELATIONSHIP

| | |
|---|---|
| NO RELATIONSHIP WITH YOU | |
| ACQUAINTANCE OF YOU | |
| FRIENDSHIP WITH YOU | |
| BEING DISCIPLED BY YOU | |

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Some of the best ministry moments happen over holidays and breaks—students are available and so are we! **Make your plan now** for how you will get into the lives of students next semester.

# DEC SEMESTER EVALUATION

*Have each team member fill out the* **Fall Semester Ministry Evaluation** *privately, tally their scores, and share the team average. Generate discussion around your team's findings.*

- How is our overall **community of students**? Are they for one another? Actively on mission? Looking to connect their friends to Jesus and one another?
- How is our overall **community as a team**? Are we for one another? Actively on mission?
- How are we doing at seeing new students joining our student ministry family?
- How is our team doing at living unleashed lives? With our few?

The goal is not to convince the team of what you think, but to **observe and learn**—you'll gain unique insights that help you lead into the future.

**CHRISTMAS BREAK PLANNING**

Christmas and New Year's offer a rhythm of rest after a long ministry sprint. Enjoy it—but relationships don't stop. **Take advantage of organic opportunities** to spend time with one another and with students!

**FALL MINISTRY EVALUATION**

Scan to download & print one copy per team member.

# JAN BE THE BRANCH



*At Southeast we value* ***connection over production****. Your connectedness to the Vine is more important than the ministry you offer or what you strive to produce.*

- Would you consider yourself to be leading from a place of "connection to Jesus" or "production for Jesus?"
- Do you feel like a connected and valued member of our student ministry? Explain.
- Do you feel like a connected and valued member of our church? Explain.
- Rate your group's connectedness from 1–10.
- Rate the connectedness of your few from 1–10.

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Sometimes we need a reset. Use this new year, not to make glamorous promises, but to grow your leadership by **remaining connected to the Vine**. Next month we talk about the Holy Spirit—the one who can help you be a better leader and follower of Jesus.

SCRIPTURE **JOHN 15:1–7**

# JAN SEMESTER PLANNING



*Same drill as the fall: do the hard work up front so everyone knows what to expect this spring.*

- Have everyone come prepared with their notable calendar dates for the semester.
  *Vacations · celebrations & family birthdays · any time they expect to be unable to lead*
- Walk through the Ministry Calendar covering leader dates, events, and other fixed items. Note conflicts as you go.
- Map out Team Meeting dates beyond the Leader Huddles.
- Lock in any extra student events your team can plan beyond program time.
- Adjust over the semester as needed—but as a team, so everyone can see what's upcoming.

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Next month we will look to mobilize groups beyond our regular ministry time.



**SPRING SEMESTER PLANNING SHEET**

Scan to download & print for this meeting.

# FEB CATCH THE WIND

CONVO 07/10

*At Southeast we value* ***risk over comfort****. Risk doesn't mean unwise actions—it means allowing the Holy Spirit to do what only He can do. To the world it might be risky; to us it's faith.*

- What's your relationship with the Holy Spirit like?
- How would you rate your dependence on the Holy Spirit for you to lead students?
- At this point in the year, how would you rate your comfort in leading your group?

  *If comfort leads to "going through the motions," it's wise to evaluate your soul.*
- What kind of risk could you take before the end of the school year to grow your dependence on the Holy Spirit's power?
- What's your big prayer?

  *A prayer that only gets answered if God shows up.*

> **LOOKING AHEAD**
>
> Around here we don't hinge our faith on numbers, but obedience. Next month we look at "Wreck the Roof." **Do you have someone you are actively seeking to share Jesus with?**

SCRIPTURE **JOHN 3:1–8**

# FEB MOBILIZING GROUPS



*How do we get our groups moving* ***out*** *?*

- Out to serving opportunities?
- Out to loving their peers one at a time?
- Out to loving their schools?
- Out to serving the church?

Summer Camp is an incredible way to get lost students in front of Jesus. Jesus built friendships first—then challenged them to more.

**Pray** and **discuss** how we can challenge students to live with purpose toward their friends at school, in hopes lost students find their way in front of Jesus at camp (or before)!

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Compile a list of our core students building friendships with purpose. By next meeting, **ask those students for names of friends to pray for**—in hopes they would come to camp.

# MAR WRECK THE ROOF



*At Southeast we value* ***innovation over tradition****. We want to dream about ways we can reach one more person with the gospel. We will stop at nothing for the Kingdom of God to expand here on earth.*

- Share a one-at-a-time story with me about someone in your group "wrecking the roof."
- Walk me through the students in your group who have taken seriously the call to reach their friends for Christ. How is it going?
- Let's dream for a moment: any ideas for how we could better reach lost students?
- This year, how can your group leverage camp to reach lost students?

  *Set a goal here.*
- Outside of student ministry, has God put anyone in your path that doesn't know Jesus?

  *Ask more questions; pray for their one.*

> **LOOKING AHEAD**
>
> It cost something for the four friends to bring their lame friend to Jesus. Next month we look at gripping the plow. Ministry can be hard, but it is always worth it. **Who on your team can you encourage this month to keep running the race?**

SCRIPTURE **LUKE 5:18–25**

# MAR RECRUITING STUDENTS



*Jesus was always recruiting—He knew the Gospel would never reach the whole world if it didn't first impact those around Him. He trained His disciples to share His Good News with a hurting world.*

- How can we "recruit" students to join the mission with us?
- What do our students need training on to become everyday missionaries?
- How do we help students get to the next level missionally?
- Do our students understand the tools of our ministry and how to use them?

  *Camp · retreats · events · program · group*
- Who is one student you could take on a "fishing trip" and show them how to fish for people? Make a plan.

**LOOKING AHEAD**

The best teacher is experience. Let's commit to **showing our students how to live like Jesus**, not just talking about it.

# APR GRIP THE PLOW



*At Southeast we value* ***personal engagement over attendance****. As a harvest worker it requires us to "grip the plow" of ministry.*

- Share some hardships you've experienced throughout this year in your ministry to students.
- Where have intentional efforts with people made things messy in your life?
- Are there any areas in your life where you are "looking back" instead of "plowing ahead" in your ministry and walk with Christ?
- Who comes to mind that best models a life of gripping the plow? How might you get some time with them to learn more?

> **LOOKING AHEAD**
>
> How much would you pay to gift eternal life to someone you love? We have the privilege of knowing where to find it—and it's free. **Next month we discuss how to express our worship for the free gift we've been given.**

SCRIPTURE **LUKE 9:57–62**

# APR STUDENT LEADERSHIP



*Growth should be expected—and can be overwhelming. This is the perfect time to establish leadership in some of your core students: they can set the pace for reaching their friends and take ownership of the group alongside you.*

- What investment now will set us up to have student leaders later?

- How can we set up our student leaders to attend camp, not for themselves, but for those coming for the first time?

- Where in our church could our students grow their leadership capabilities?

  *Serve teams · SE!Kids · classes*

**LOOKING AHEAD**

Next month we evaluate our semester and map out a summer plan. **Come ready to discuss** anything you feel is important, plus ideas for staying connected over the summer.

# MAY EMPTY THE JAR



*At Southeast we value* ***expressive worship over religious rituals****. We give Jesus our everything because He gave His everything for us. In Christ alone we find our worth.*

- Share a time where being generous cost you something.

- In what ways do you express your love for Jesus?
  *Likely obvious, but worth saying out loud.*

- How would you rate your generosity with time? With relationships? With finances?

- Do you have anything in your jar that is still needing to be emptied?

**LOOKING AHEAD**

With summer approaching, what are some ways you can continue developing as a leader over the next two months? **Let's make a plan so we don't return the same in the fall!**

SCRIPTURE **LUKE 7:36–50**

# MAY SEMESTER EVALUATION

*Have each team member fill out the* ***Spring Semester Ministry Evaluation*** *privately, tally scores, and share the team average. Discuss the findings together.*

- How is our overall **community of students**? For one another? Actively on mission? Connecting friends to Jesus and one another?
- How is our overall **community as a team**?
- How are we doing at seeing new students join our student ministry family?
- How is our team doing at living unleashed lives? With our few?

**SUMMER PLANNING**

Sync up and plan the summer so your team knows what to expect. Summer rhythms are less regular, but that doesn't mean we take off. **Find intentional ways to invest through the summer!**

**SPRING MINISTRY EVALUATION**

Scan to download & print one copy per team member.

05

SECTION 05

# BIG THREE

MSM + HSM. Three times a year we gather all our Student Ministry leaders together.

ALL LEADERS · THREE TIMES A YEAR

# THE BIG THREE

**These are high priority events for our ministry. We expect you and your team to be fully present.**

The Big Three are also a pivotal part of our onboarding process for new leaders. Connected to each one, we host an **Unleashed Leader Training** for all new and potential leaders to on-ramp into our ministry—with flexibility for onboarding when we aren't near one of those planned starting points.

Your participation at each of these keystone moments is vital. We believe these moments together as a Student Ministry are foundational to keeping us aligned. **Be in tune with these dates each year—we need you to champion them to your teams!**

# EVENTS + TIPS

## AUGUST
### Leader Launch

Vision cast + launch into the new school year.

**TIP**

The time to consider Leader Launch is May. Recruit to camp = recruit to fall.

## JANUARY
### Leader Night

Reset + halftime speech for second semester.

**TIP**

The time to consider Leader Night is August. Get it on your leaders' calendars early and remind them.

## MAY
### Leader Celebration

Celebrate all that God has done.

**TIP**

The time to consider Leader Celebration is January. It might be a starting point for some new leaders going to camp.

PRECEDING EACH OF THE BIG THREE

# UNLEASHED LEADERS (ALL YEAR)

**Unleashed Leaders is a deep dive into our "why"**—a training we expect every new leader to go through.

It sets up new leaders to learn who we are as a Student Ministry. Whether someone joins to lead a group or serve at check-in, they need to know our primary aim is to make disciples. We look at the life of Christ and allow it to inform how we approach ministry.

Since Jesus himself continually raised the bar for his disciples, we inform those joining us about the cost of following Jesus up front, so later they aren't surprised by what we ask of them. In some ways it can appear we are talking people out of doing ministry. In actuality, we are just echoing Jesus' call to make disciples—even some who heard it straight from Jesus' mouth chose not to follow.

We know things happen—but being up front about the commitment pays dividends when leaders know what they are signing up for and stick it out. **We love the community of leaders God has blessed us with. We get to fulfill Jesus' mission together!**

06

SECTION 06

# FURTHER RESOURCES

Learn more. A compilation of resources to be used à la carte—explore at your own pace.

EQUIPPED FOR THE ROLE

# WE BELIEVE IN YOU

**As a leader leading other leaders, your role is vital to our ministry to students.** We desire to equip you spiritually just as much as we desire to equip you with ministry resources.

That is why you have this booklet in the first place. Mixed throughout it are resources we hope you find valuable personally and in your Team Leader role.

The rest of this booklet is a compilation of resources to be used à la carte. We might reference these during our Team Leader Meetings at times, but they are there for you to explore and use at your own desire and pace.

CONNECTING NEW LEADERS

# FIRST STEPS

01 **PRAY**
FOR HARVEST WORKERS

02 **IDENTIFY**
POTENTIAL LEADERS

03 **INVITE**
SECC.ORG/SERVE

04 **INTERVIEW**
CLEARING PROCESS

05 **SHADOW**
A LEADER

06 **TRAIN**
MINISTRY + SPECIFICS

07 **INTRODUCE**
TO STUDENTS

**SECC.ORG/SERVE**
Potential leaders fill out the interest form—it notifies staff and starts onboarding.

# NEW LEADERS

Over time you will add new leaders onto your team. Leaders can come from a lot of places and at different times throughout the year, and we want to make sure they join our ministry well. Staff will work with Team Leaders in various ways to create the best experience possible for a potential leader joining our ministry.

**Once a leader is placed onto your team, identifying their gifting early on helps you understand what they bring.** We recommend taking them through the High5test to identify strengths they might bring to the team.

Looking at the strengths of each of your teammates helps you lead them to take ownership over different aspects of your ministry to students. It is your job to help your team play to their strengths, offering their gifts in service to God's Kingdom.



**HIGH5TEST**

A free strengths assessment—have every new teammate take it and discuss the results together.

JESUS + THE TWELVE

# CASE STUDY: EFFECTIVE TEAM

Jesus had a team of 12 "called out" ones. This team functioned like any other ministry team—serving others together, sharing the gospel, going to unreached places, loving those who came their way.

**READ** **Luke 9:46–50**

What were the disciples arguing about?

**READ** **Luke 22:24–27**

What is different about this confrontation?

**READ** **Matthew 20:20–28**

How did Jesus address this issue?

**THINK** **What would have happened if Jesus didn't address this issue?**

> **YOU ARE THE UNIFIER**
>
> Disagreements, misunderstandings, or flat-out ignorance will take place—at times you might be the source. Jesus wasn't just full of grace and truth; **Jesus led from grace and truth**. Your team needs you to lead like Jesus, willing to speak hard truths full of grace, before disunity arises.

FIVE THINGS TO DEFINE

# BUILDING AN EFFECTIVE TEAM



### Define Goals & Purpose Up Front

**Teams that lack direction usually fizzle out**

- How will your team practically live on mission?
- Can you rally around a common goal?



### Define Framework

**Structure to operate within**

- How does your team share responsibilities?
- Does your team understand how things are supposed to work?



### Define Communication

**The thread that keeps everyone in the know**

- What is your method(s) of communication?
- How / when will 1-on-1s and team meetings be accomplished?



### Define Accountability

**Creates trust, deepens commitment**

- As the team leader, do you allow yourself to be held accountable?
- How is your team accountable to one another?



### Define Unity

**The fruit of deep commitment to one another**

- When frustration develops on the team, how do we handle it?
- Can your team disagree and still feel valued and loved?

FOR YOU & YOUR TEAM

# MANTRA QUESTIONS



## BE THE BRANCH John 15:1–17

- How is my connection to the vine? My team's?
- How could I encourage my team to stay connected?



## CATCH THE WIND John 3:1–8

- Where is the Spirit moving in our church and community that we could join?
- What risk will we take that causes us to truly depend on God to move?



## WRECK THE ROOF Luke 5:18–25

- How could we reach more students in this city?
- Who is my one? Who are my students' ones?



## GRIP THE PLOW Luke 9:57–62

- Where do I find myself making excuses to avoid ministry?
- Where might God be asking me to focus my ministry efforts?



## EMPTY THE JAR Luke 7:36–50 · 2 Cor. 12:15

- Where can I spend and be spent for others to know Christ?
- Am I generous with my time and availability? Where could I sacrifice more?

LEADERSHIP IS CAUGHT, NOT TAUGHT

# DEVELOPING LEADERS

Leadership is more often caught through watching qualified people than through your own individuality. Debrief each phase with three questions: **What worked? What didn't? How can we improve?**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **01** | **I DO.<br>YOU WATCH.<br>WE TALK.** | The new leader shadows an experienced leader a few times, then they meet to debrief what was observed. |
| **02** | **I DO.<br>YOU HELP.<br>WE TALK.** | The new leader helps lead a particular area—announcements and prayer, say, while the experienced leader leads the talk. Follow up one-on-one. |
| **03** | **YOU DO.<br>I HELP.<br>WE TALK.** | The new leader transitions from supporting to taking leadership responsibilities. The experienced leader follows up to debrief. |
| **04** | **YOU DO.<br>I WATCH.<br>WE TALK.** | The new leader fulfills all the functions of leadership, with the experienced leader now looking on. |
| **05** | **YOU DO.** | The new leader is successfully leading in our ministry and is placed on your team. |

“

**BUSYNESS DOES NOT MEAN YOU ARE A FAITHFUL OR FRUITFUL CHRISTIAN. IT ONLY MEANS YOU ARE BUSY, JUST LIKE EVERYONE ELSE. AND LIKE EVERYONE ELSE, YOUR JOY, YOUR HEART AND YOUR SOUL ARE IN DANGER.**

— KEVIN DEYOUNG

THE NEGLECTED PRIORITY

# REST

Rest might be one of the most important, yet often neglected priorities in our relationship with God. Think about the last time you heard—or said: *"I'm good, I'm just tired." · "I just need a vacation soon." · "I feel burnt out." · "Just need more hours in the day."*

**Our ability to lead people often hinges on our ability to rest well.**

Jesus provides a solution to our hurried living. He modeled a life of rest amidst the demands of everyday life—in tune with his deep need to connect to the Father. Rest reveals a posture of the heart that is deeply dependent upon God. We must continually check ourselves: how much stock do I put in my **production for Christ** over my **connectedness to Christ**?

**"EREMOS PLACE" SOLITARY RETREAT GUIDE**

If you find yourself weary, do this yourself before you try to lead others into it. Whether for you or your team, this guide helps get you reconnected to the Vine.

SPACE TO THINK

# NOTES

SPACE TO THINK

# NOTES

SPACE TO DRAW

# SKETCH


Southeast
Students
TEAM LEADERS